LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses. Owns ingestion and orchestration across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka, with hands-on experience using Python, SQL and AWS data services. Delivered measurable improvements in pipeline latency, warehouse build times, database load and data-platform costs. Mentors engineers and contributes to open-source data tooling.

CORE SKILLS

Data platform engineering | Python | SQL | Snowflake | AWS | Kafka | Airflow | dbt | Data ingestion and orchestration | Data modelling and transformation | Query and warehouse optimisation | Data quality and testing | CI/CD | Terraform | Great Expectations | PostgreSQL | PySpark | Redshift | GitHub Actions

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. 2022–Present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform, using Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka.
- Participate in the data-platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Mentor two mid-level engineers and run data-platform office hours.
- Sized Snowflake warehouses, enabled auto-suspend and removed unused tables; reduced the monthly bill from approximately 38k to 24k in 2024.
- Designed and built a shipment-event streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling so failed shipment events can be reprocessed without data loss.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt models with tests and documentation; introduced incremental models and slim CI using state:modified in GitHub Actions.
- Reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes and made data lineage visible to analysts.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay 2019–2022

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR and designed Redshift warehouse solutions.
- Worked on data quality using Great Expectations.
- Built a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers using PySpark on EMR.
- Reduced the finance team's manual reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTION

Airflow provider package fixes 2023

- Fixed a pagination bug and added tests for a community Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API; two pull requests were merged.
- Technologies: Python, Airflow, pytest.

EDUCATION

MSc, Computer Science | Northgate Technical University

Thesis: Incremental materialized views

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024

COMMUNITY & SPEAKING

- Teach beginner SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.